

TASK 1 – ANALYSE

Scrum Element Still works? Why / Why not?

2-week sprints	Partially	The team can still work in short iterations, but frequent requirement changes from Austin and unresolved architecture decisions may make sprint goals unstable.
Definition of Done	Difficult	Different locations have different expectations. A feature may be technically complete but fail legal, UX, or customer requirements. FERPA and GDPR requirements must be included in the DoD.
Backlog prioritization	Problematic	Austin receives new requirements weekly, but there is no structured process to feed them into the backlog. Priorities may constantly shift.
Sprint Review Demo	Still works	Reviews help align stakeholders and gather feedback early, which is especially important because university stakeholders disagree on requirements.
Velocity tracking	Less reliable	Constant requirement changes, blockers, and architecture conflicts make velocity an inaccurate predictor of future delivery.

TASK 2 – DECIDE

SITUATION A – WHOSE DESIGN WINS?

a. Which option do you choose?

Option 3: Ship the MVP with the weaker UX, then redesign after pilot feedback.

Why:

- The MVP deadline is only 9 months away.
- A 3-month redesign threatens the entire project schedule.
- The pilot customer can provide evidence about whether the personalization feature is truly valuable.
- Building something usable now reduces the risk of spending months solving a problem that users may not care about.

b. Who has authority to make this call?

The Product Owner (or Head of Product) should make the final decision because it is a business trade-off between customer value, technical feasibility, and delivery risk.

If Amsterdam and Bangalore cannot agree:

1. Both teams present evidence.
2. Engineering explains technical constraints.
3. Product explains customer impact.
4. Product Owner makes the final decision and documents the rationale.
- 5.
6. SITUATION B – THE ONLY MEETING SLOT

a. Which item do you drop?

Drop Item 2: Review the 6 new university requirements.

Why?

Items 1 and 3 are actively blocking development:

- Bangalore cannot continue effectively without the data model.
- The architecture conflict has already delayed the project for two weeks.

The new requirements are important, but they do not create an immediate development blockage.

b. How do you handle it differently?

Use asynchronous collaboration:

- Austin documents requirements in a shared backlog.
- Amsterdam and Bangalore review them before the meeting.
- Product Owner prioritizes and comments asynchronously.
- Any remaining questions are handled through written discussions or a smaller follow-up meeting.

1. This prevents critical engineering decisions from being delayed.
- 2.
3. SITUATION C – THE LEGAL BLOCKER

a. Which option do you choose?

Option 3: Redirect Bangalore to another product area such as LMS integration.

Why?

- Waiting 6–8 weeks wastes expensive engineering capacity.
- Synthetic data may create an engine optimized for unrealistic behavior.
- LMS integration is already requested by the university and can progress independently of student data.

This keeps the team productive while reducing technical risk.

b. How do you communicate the decision?

Example message:

The FERPA approval process has created a dependency we cannot control. Rather than pause work or build against uncertain assumptions, we will temporarily focus on LMS integration and supporting platform capabilities. This is not a cancellation of recommendation-engine work; it is a risk-management decision that keeps the project moving while legal approval is completed. Once compliance is approved, we will resume recommendation development with real requirements and data.

TASK 3 – REFLECT

a. Which situation revealed the biggest structural weakness?

Situation B revealed the biggest weakness: communication and decision-making across locations. Critical information is trapped in different teams, and there is no effective process for sharing requirements and resolving conflicts quickly.

b. What should change?

LearnLoop needs a stronger product governance process with:

- A clear Product Owner responsible for priorities.
- A single shared backlog.
- Formal requirement handoff procedures between Austin, Amsterdam, and Bangalore.
- Regular asynchronous decision documentation.

These changes would reduce delays caused by geography, time zones, and unclear ownership.

AI ANALYSIS

Possible counterarguments to the chosen options

Situation A (against Option 3):

A strong argument for Option 2 is that architecture debt becomes harder and more expensive to remove later. If real-time personalization is the platform's main competitive advantage, postponing the redesign could create long-term technical limitations and disappoint the pilot customer.

Situation B (against dropping Item 2):

The six new requirements might contain critical legal or business constraints. Delaying them could cause the team to build features that later need rework, wasting more time than the engineering blockers.

Situation C (against Option 3):

Option 2 could allow the recommendation team to continue learning and experimenting. Even if synthetic data is imperfect, valuable infrastructure, evaluation pipelines, and ML workflows could still be built during the waiting period.

Reflection

The strongest counterargument is probably for Situation A: delaying architectural improvements can create technical debt that becomes extremely expensive later. However, given the hard 9-month MVP deadline, delivering a working pilot remains the higher priority.

1. I would keep all three decisions because they balance delivery risk, team productivity, and stakeholder needs better than the alternatives under the stated constraints.